Unit 2

Chords in Both Hands

New: Right-hand three-note chords; 2/4 time

Now the right hand plays chords too. A right-hand chord sits under the tune: the top note is the melody, and the two notes below it fill in the harmony. This unit also brings a new time signature, 2/4: two quarter-note beats in a bar, the time of marches and polkas.

What is new

Right-hand chords

Read the top note first: it is the tune. Then recognise the shape below it, two notes a third or fourth apart, all from the same chord as the left hand.

Chorale

A chorale is a hymn texture: every beat is a chord, in both hands, and the music moves slowly in half notes. Listen for the top line.

2/4 time

Two quarter-note beats in each bar: ONE two, ONE two. A half note fills the whole bar. The oom-pah bass in 2/4 is one 'oom' and one 'pah' per bar.

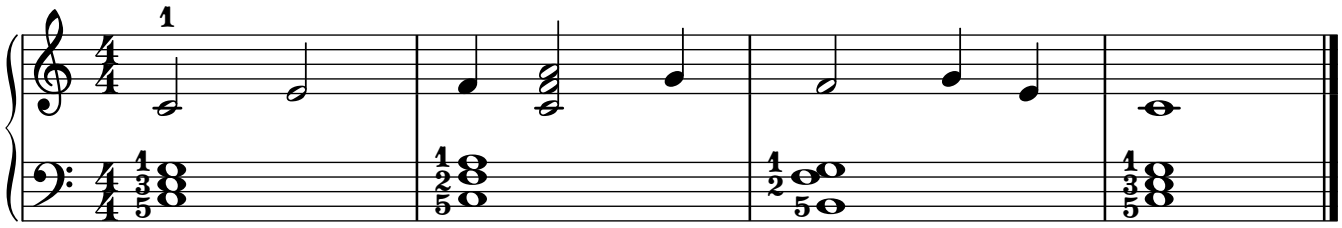
Reading tips

1. Look at the top note of each right-hand chord and follow the tune from top note to top note.
2. Drop the whole hand onto a chord, so all three notes sound exactly together.
3. In 2/4, feel a strong beat at every bar line, like marching feet: LEFT right, LEFT right.
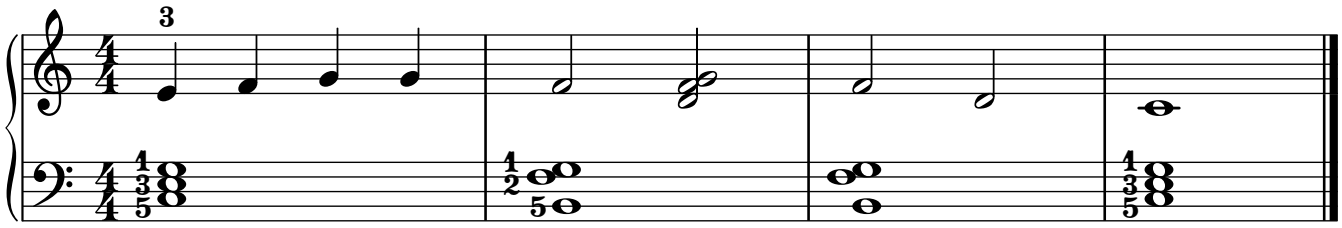
Part A: Chords on the long notes ♩ = 60

C major: right-hand chords on the long notes, block chords in the left hand.

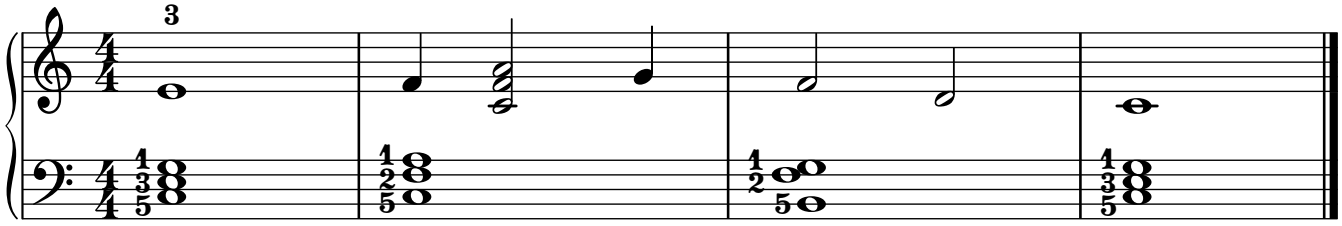
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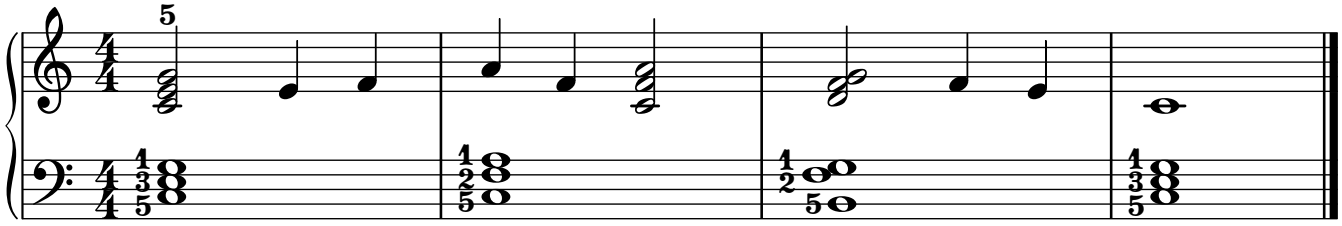
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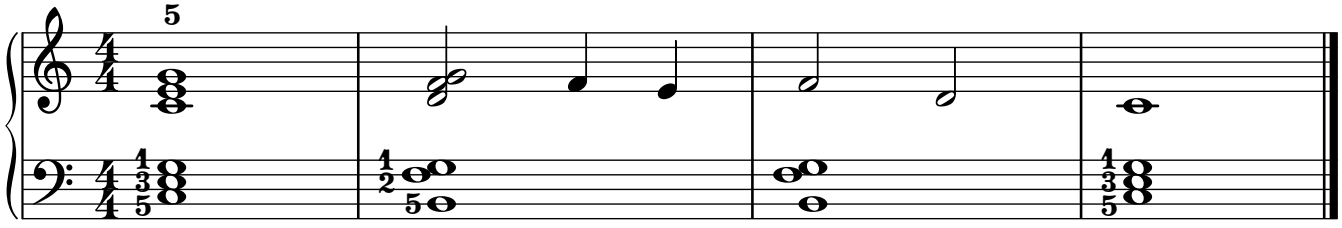
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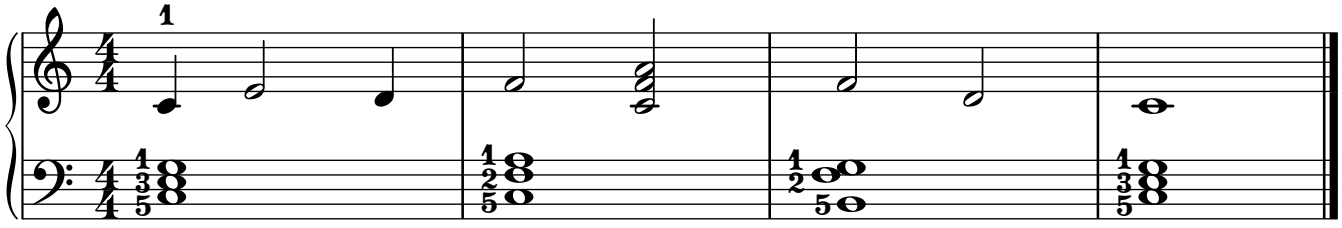
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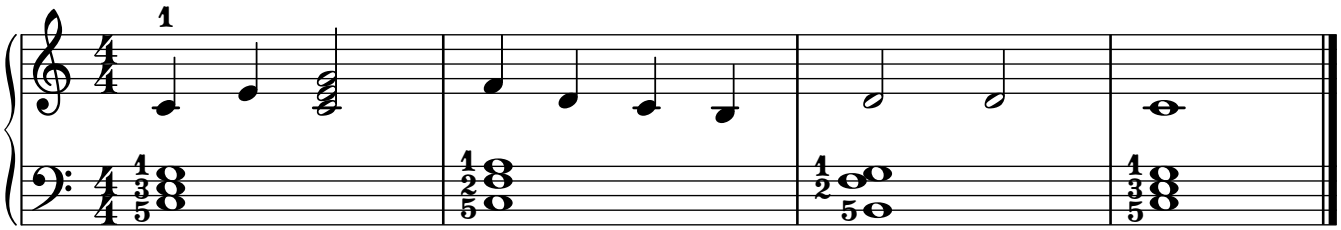
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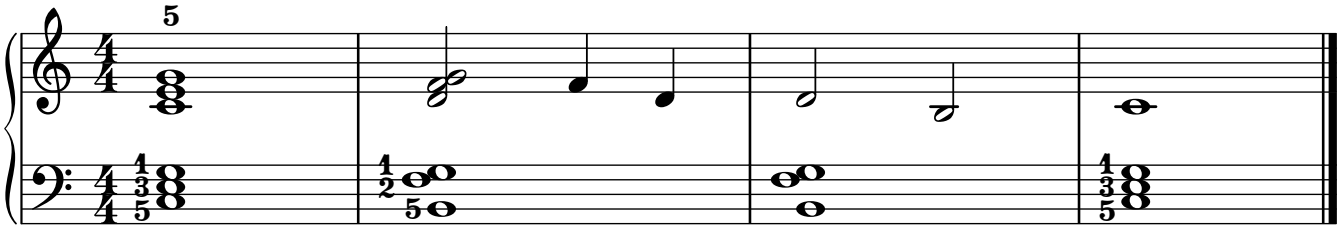


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☐ **2.7**
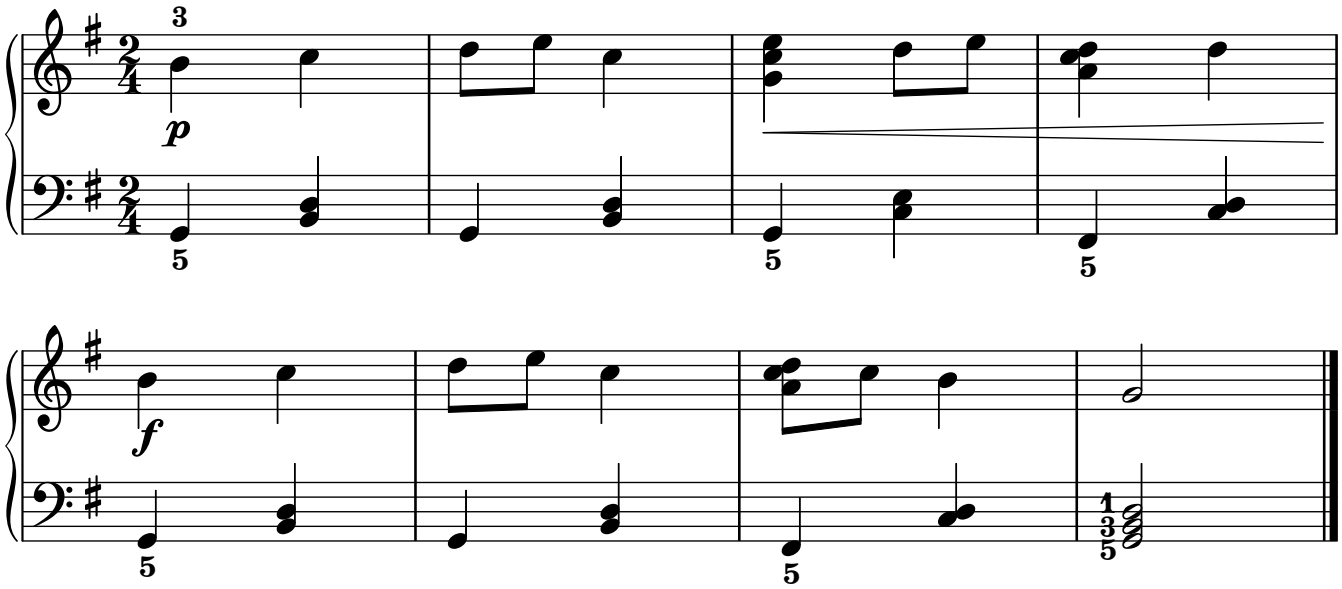


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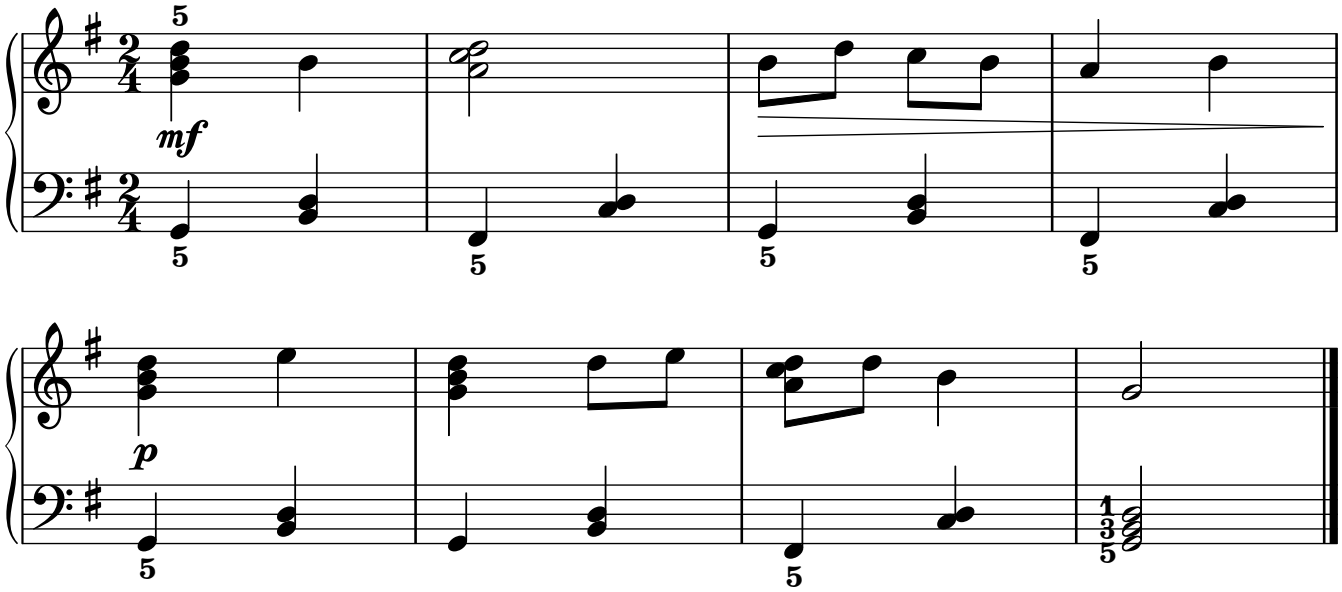


Part B: A march in 2/4 ♩ = 88

A march in 2/4, G major: right-hand chords on the beat, oom-pah in the left hand.

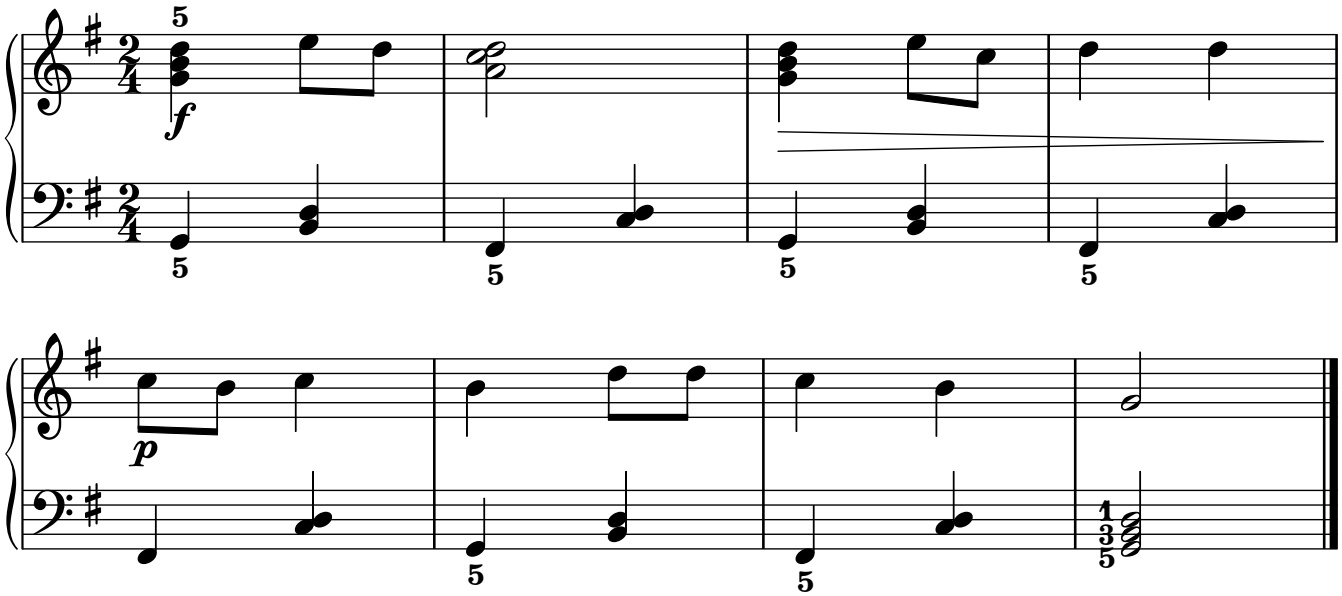
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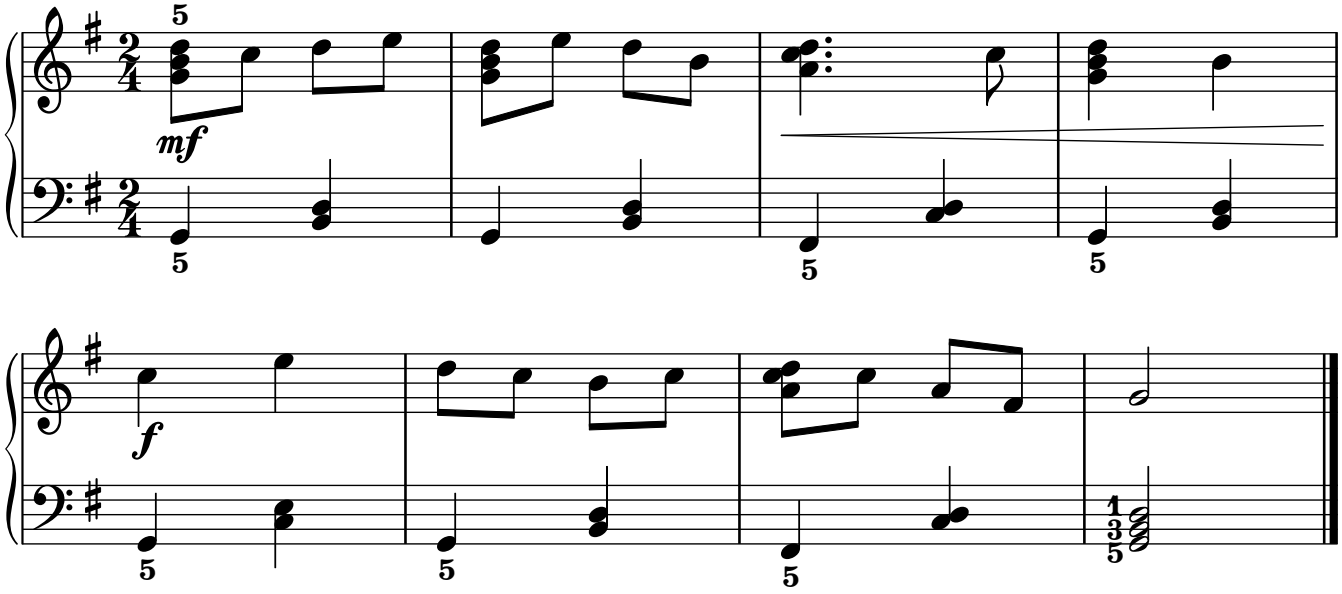
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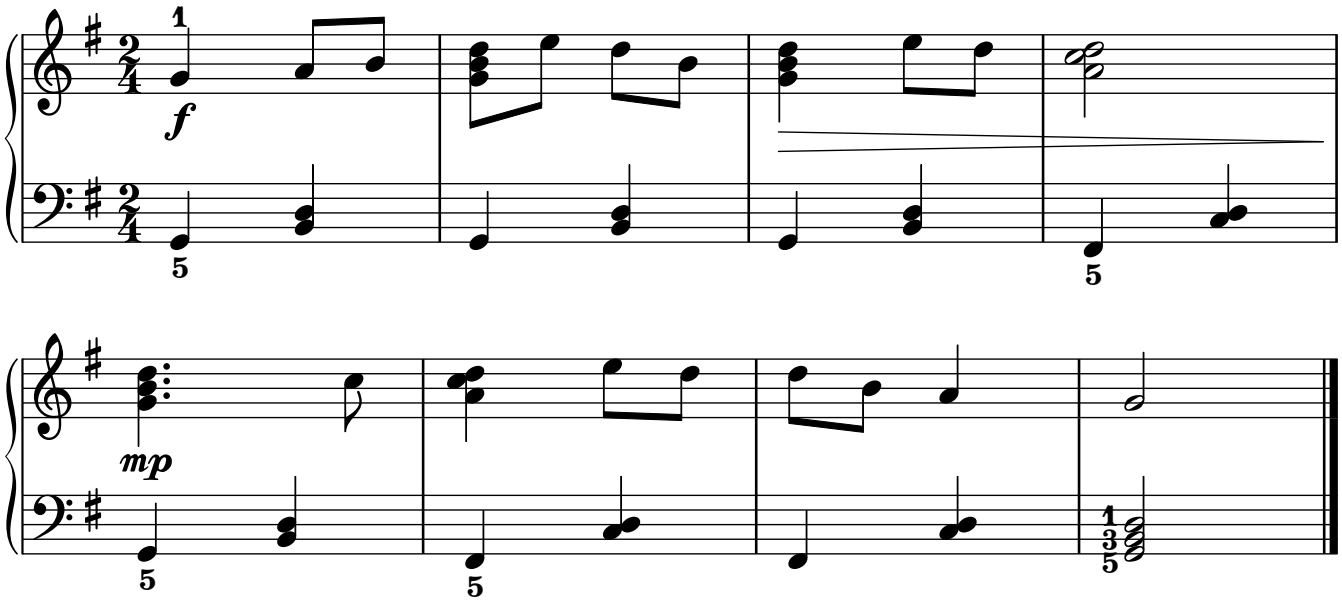


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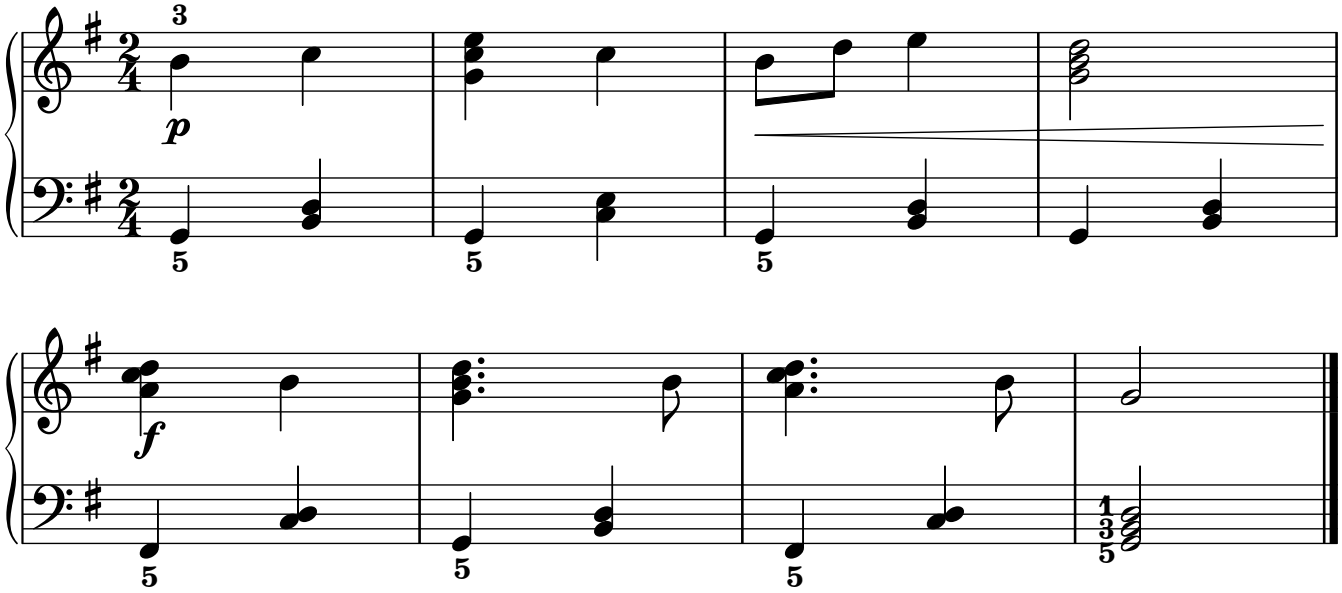


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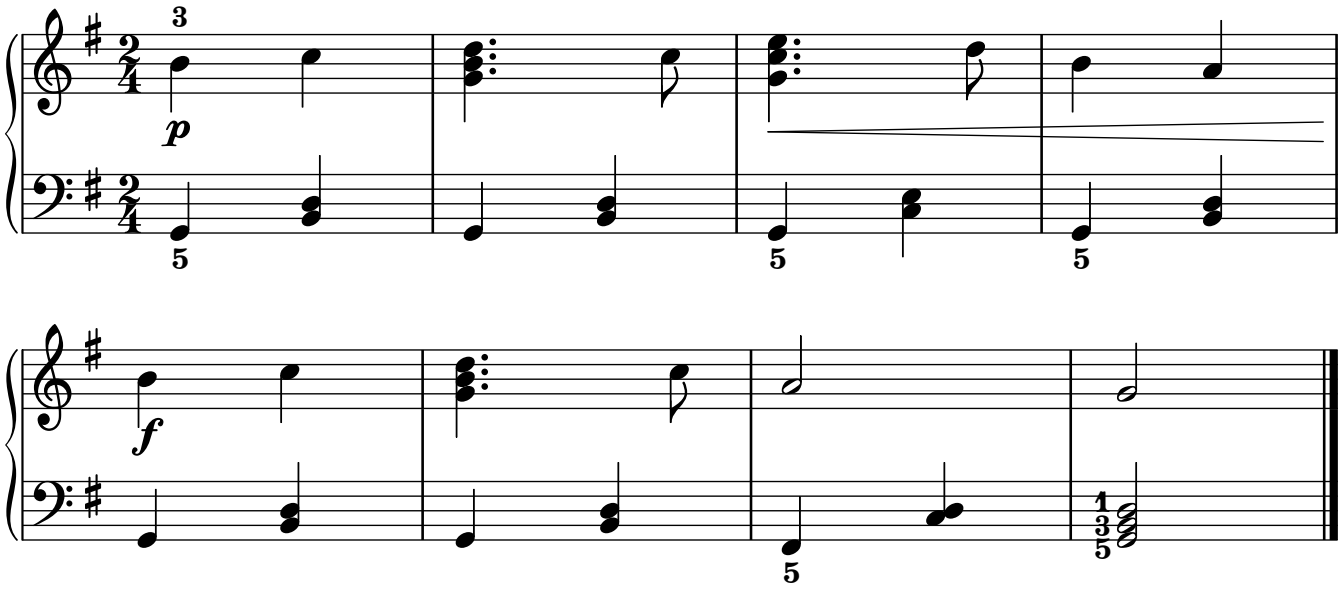
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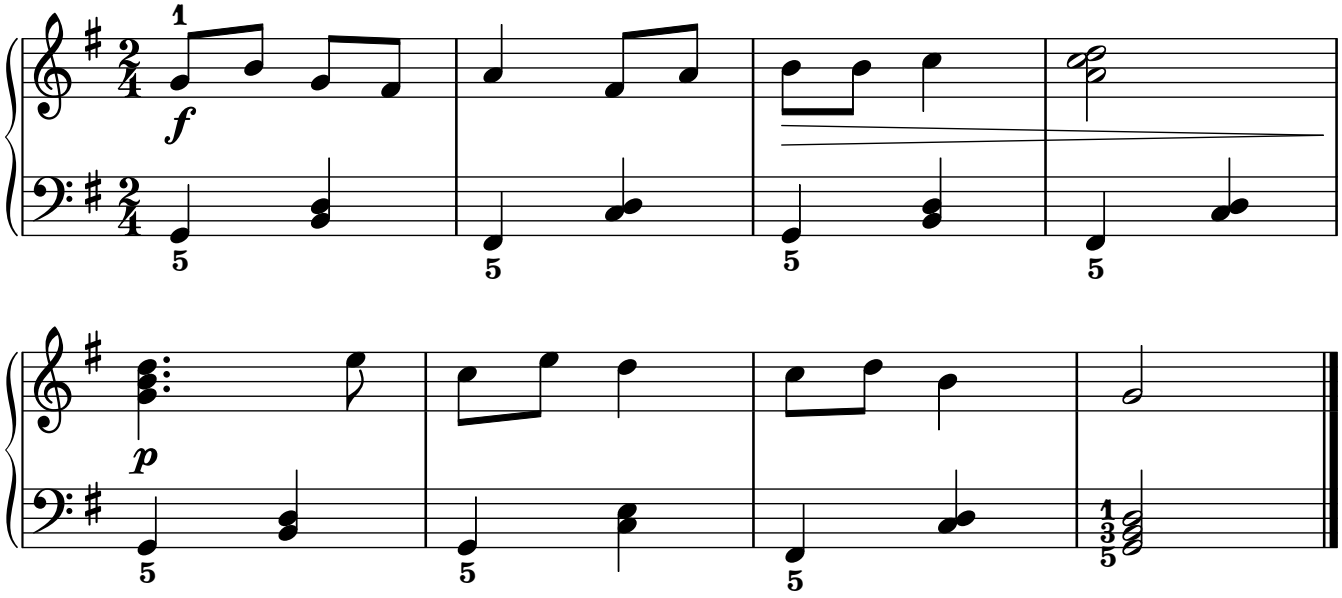
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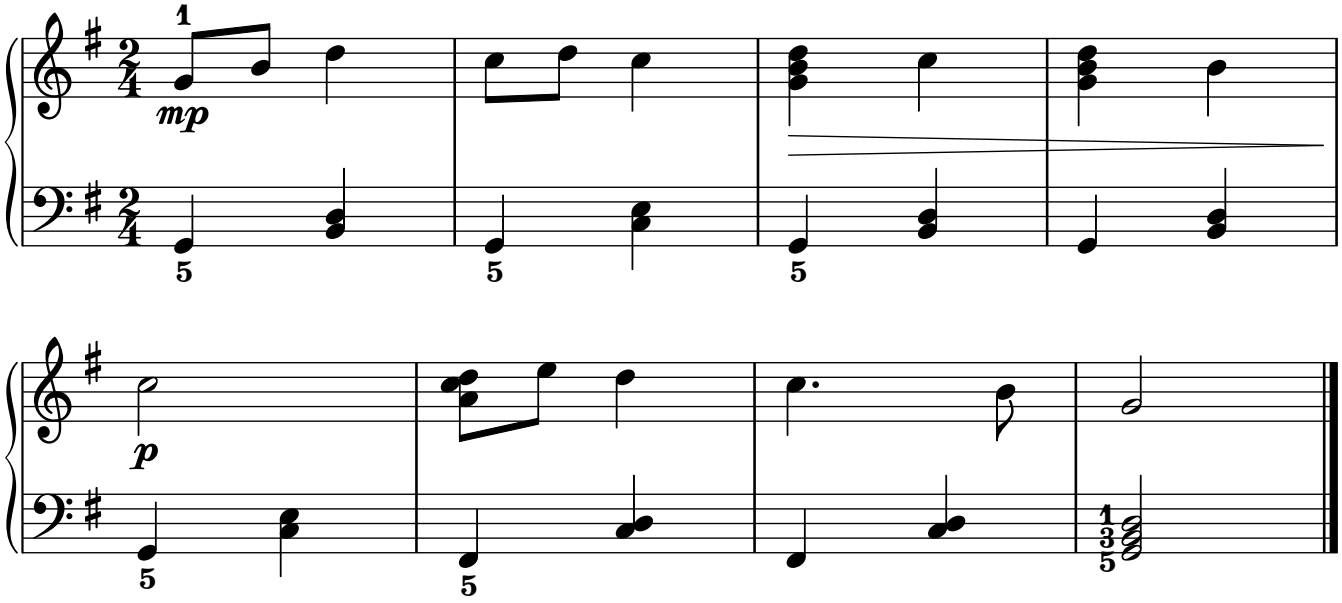


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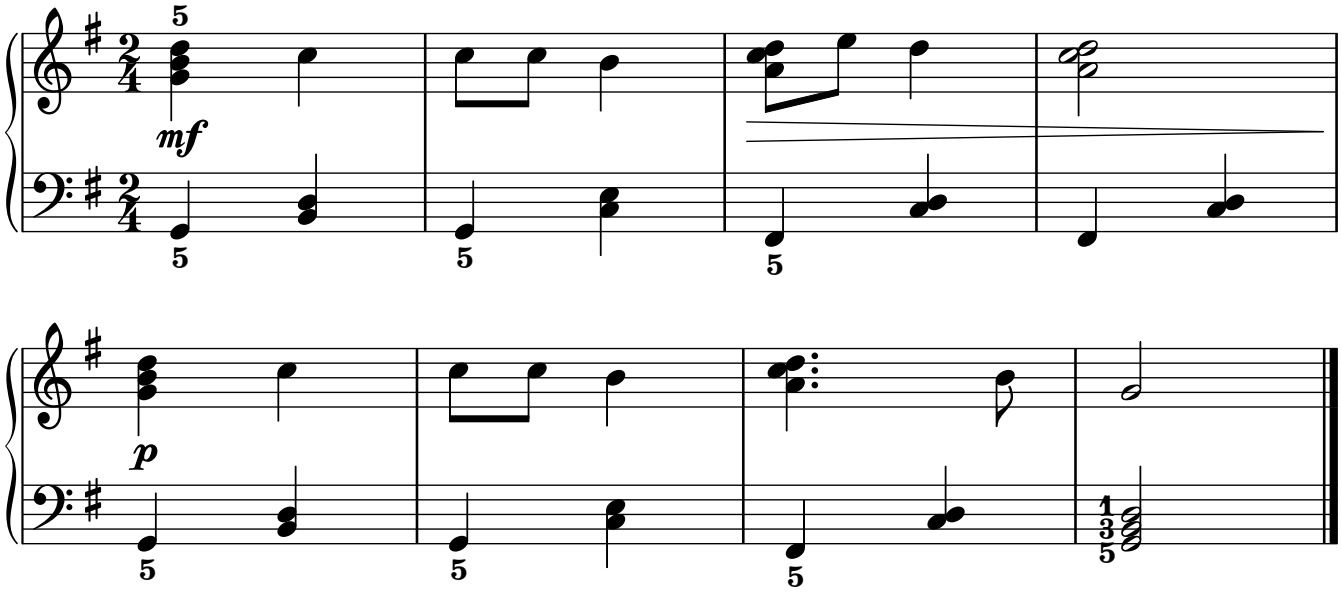


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2.17



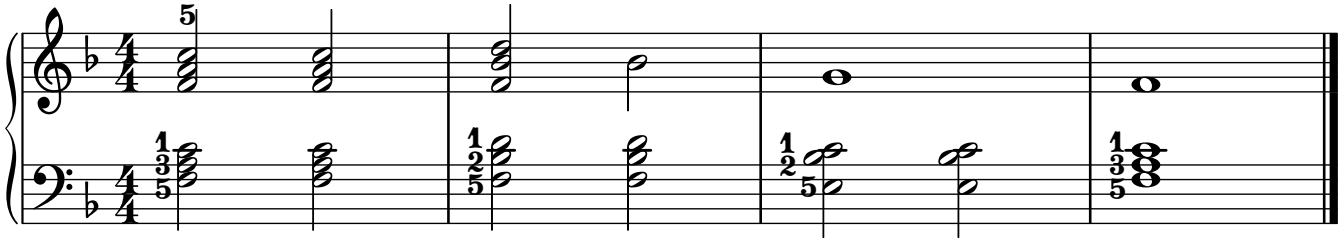
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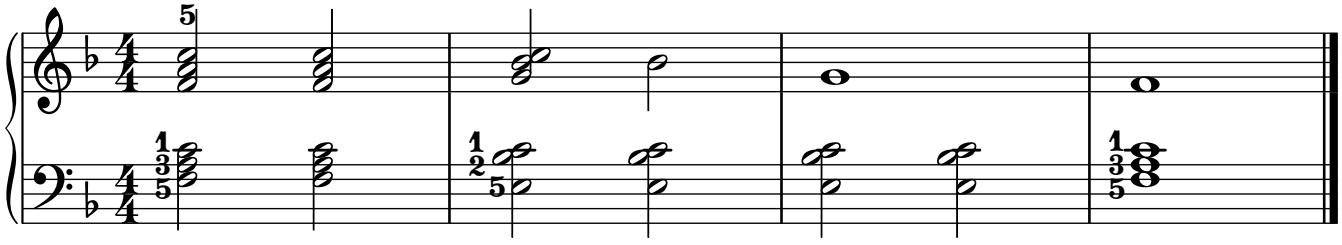


Part C: Chorale: chords in both hands ♩ = 60

F major in half notes, chords in both hands.

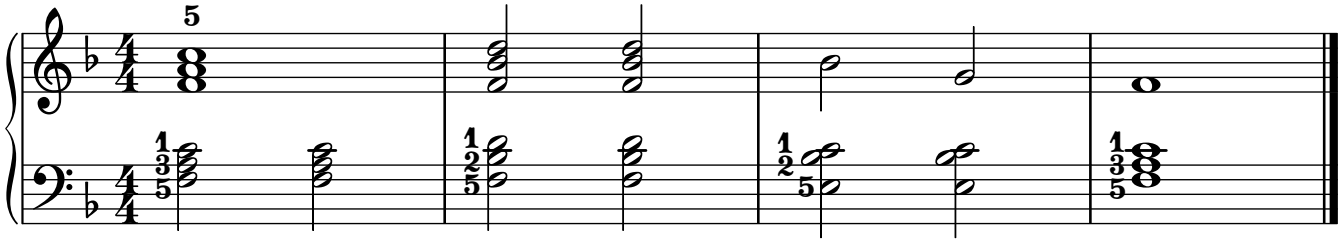
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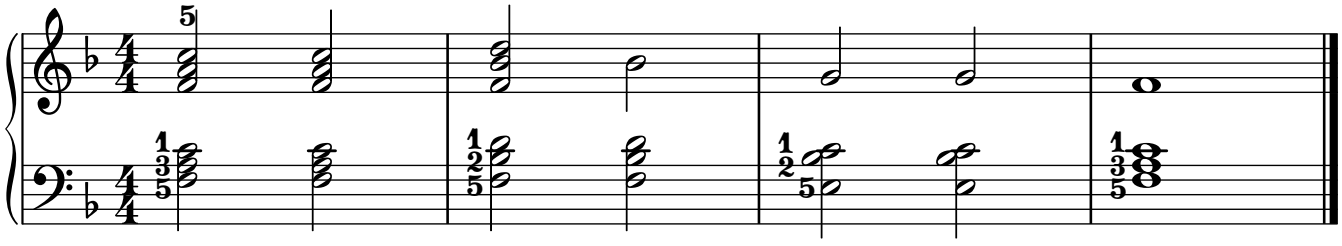
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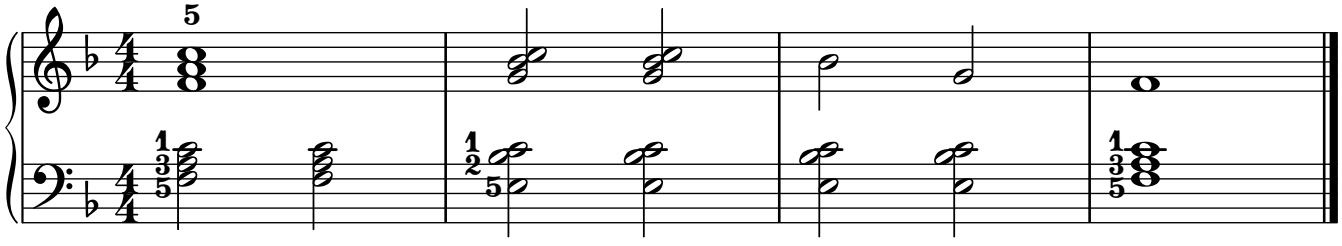
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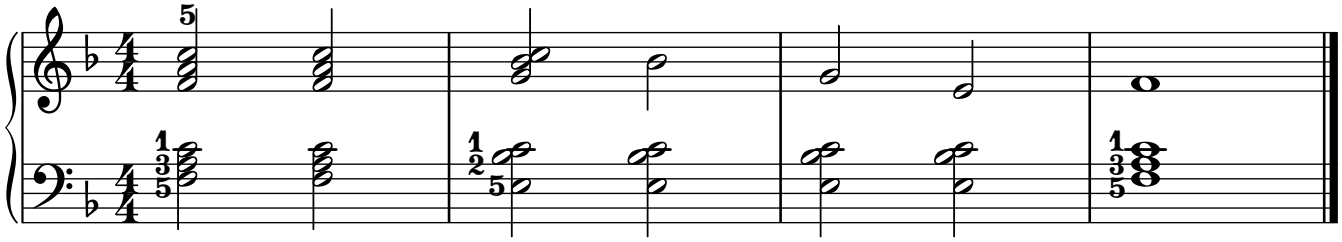


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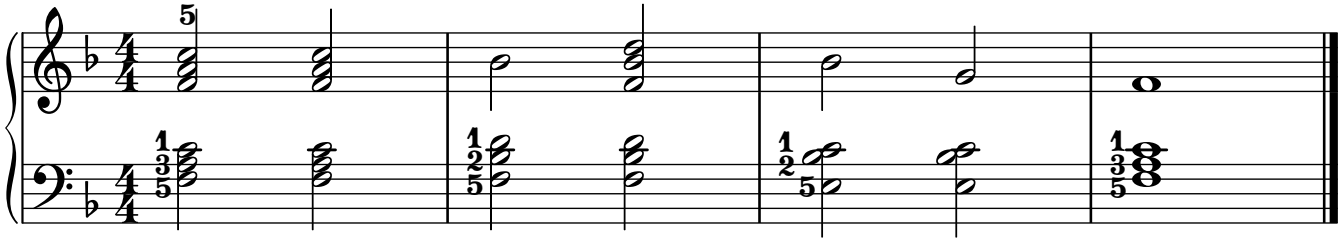
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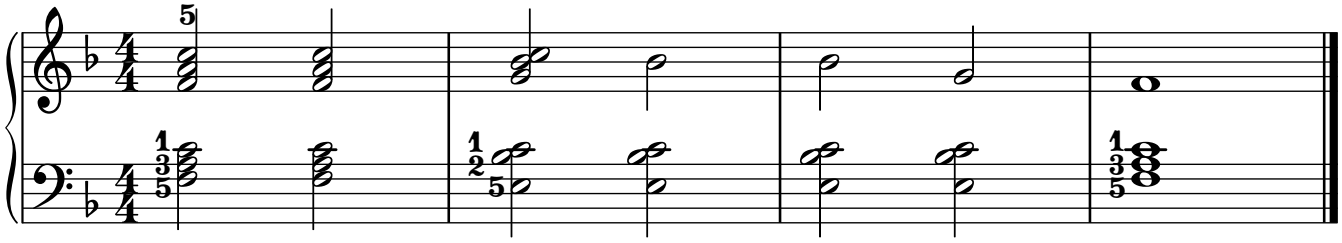
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☐ **2.25**



☐ **2.26**
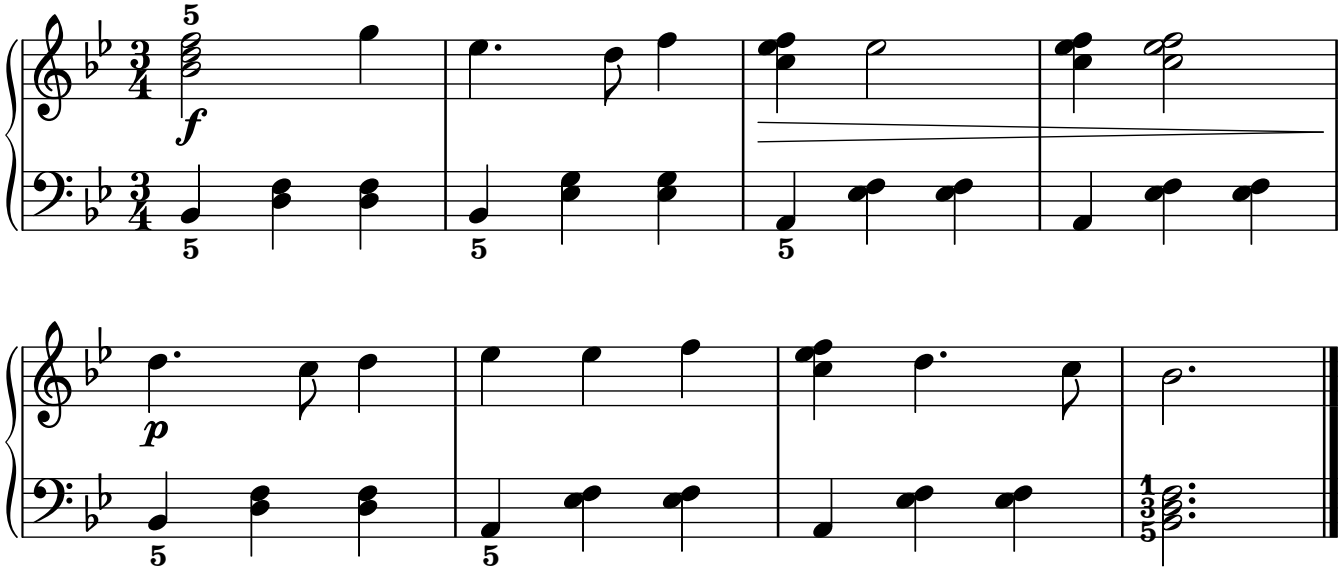


Part D: A B-flat waltz with chords
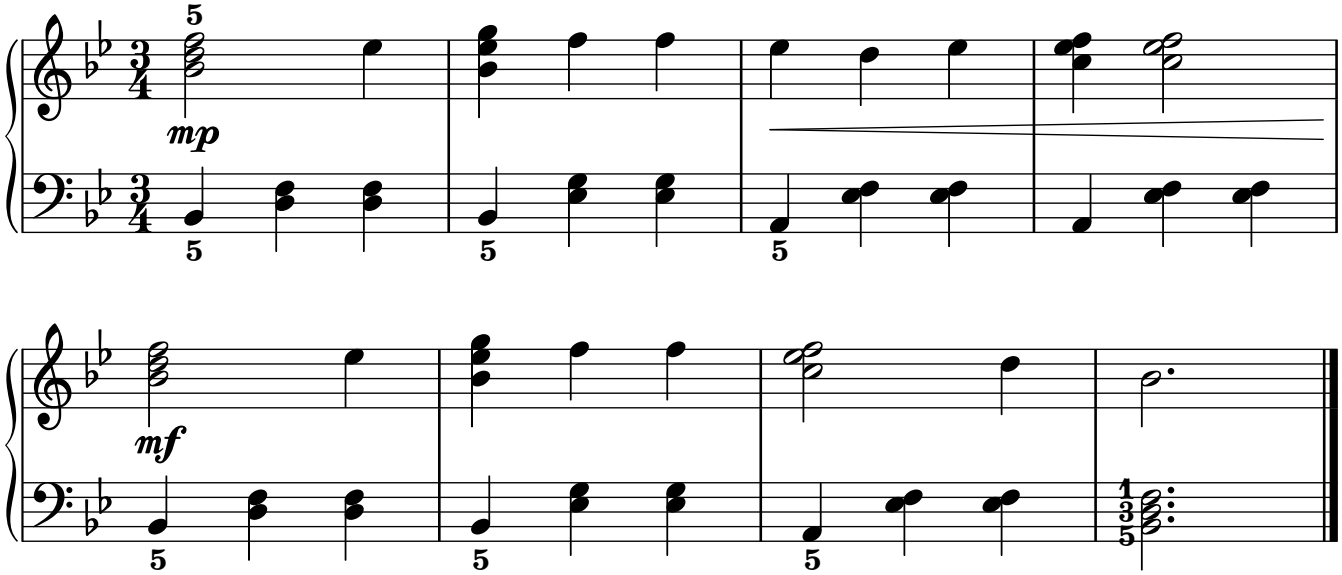
♩ = 84

A B-flat major waltz with right-hand chords on the beat.

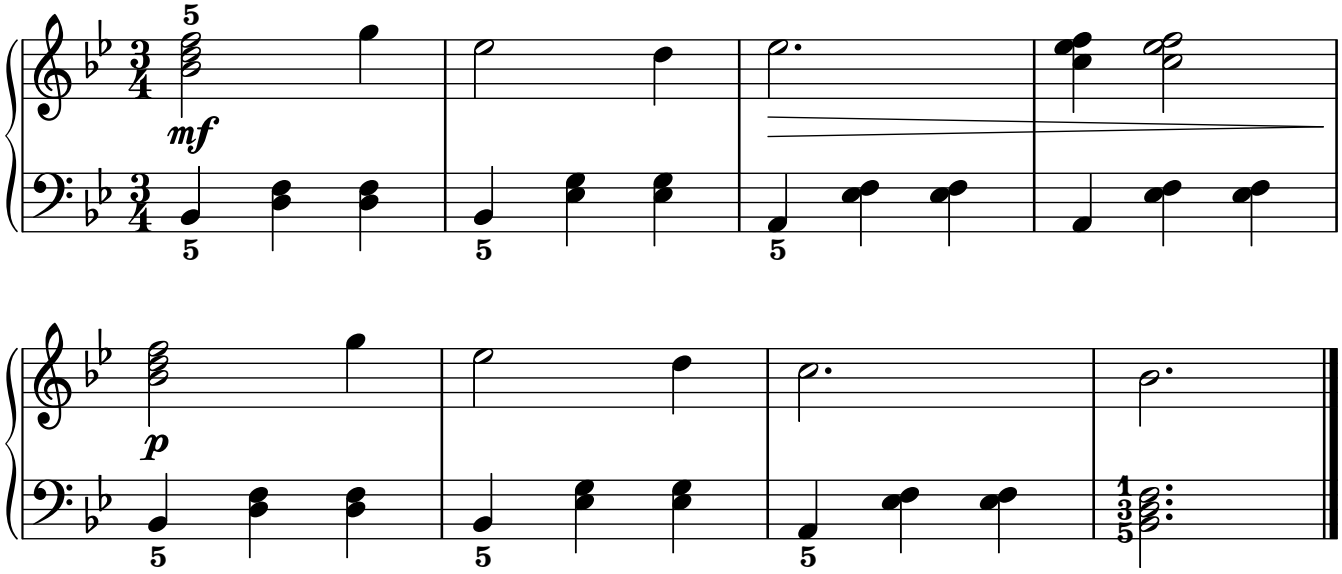
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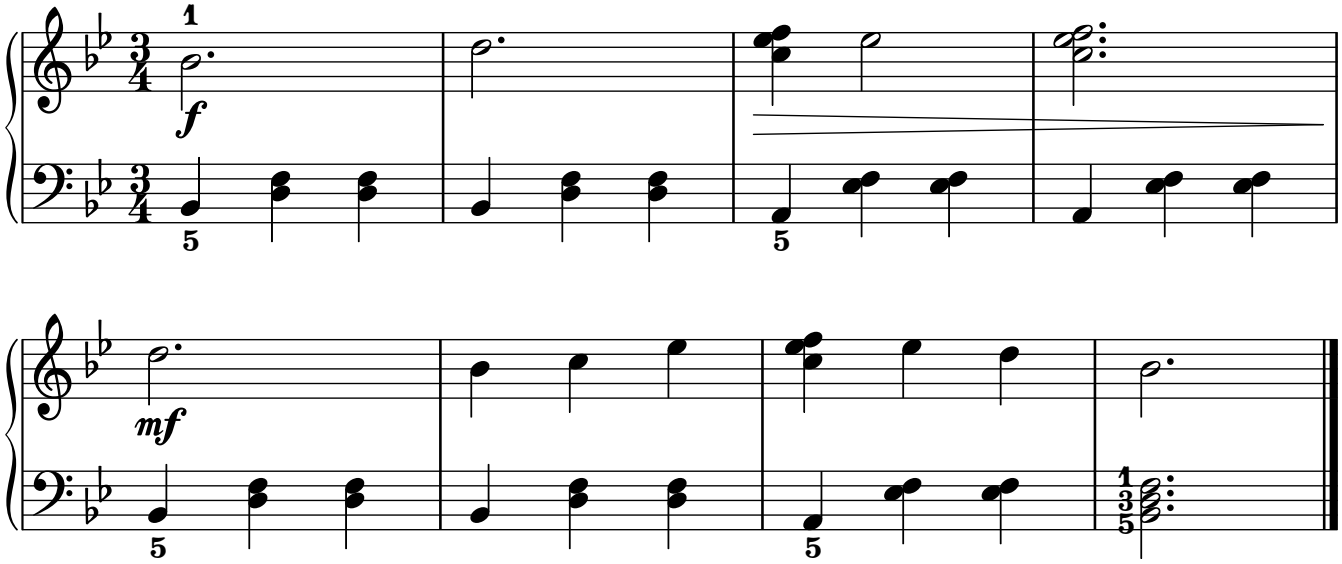
☐ **2.28**



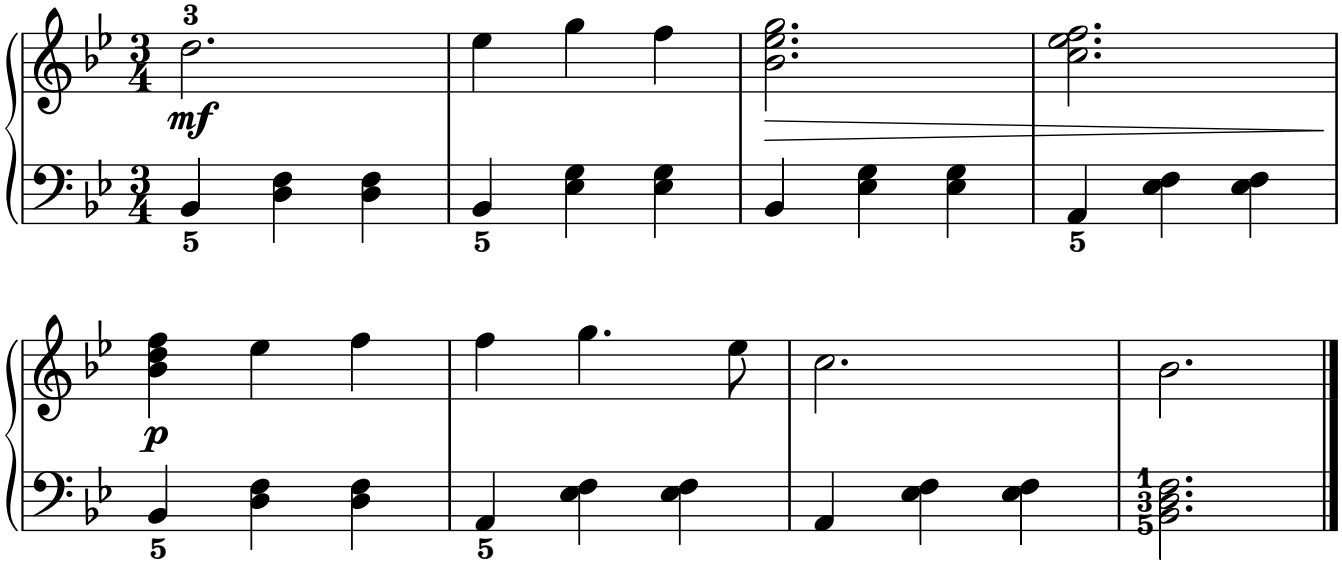
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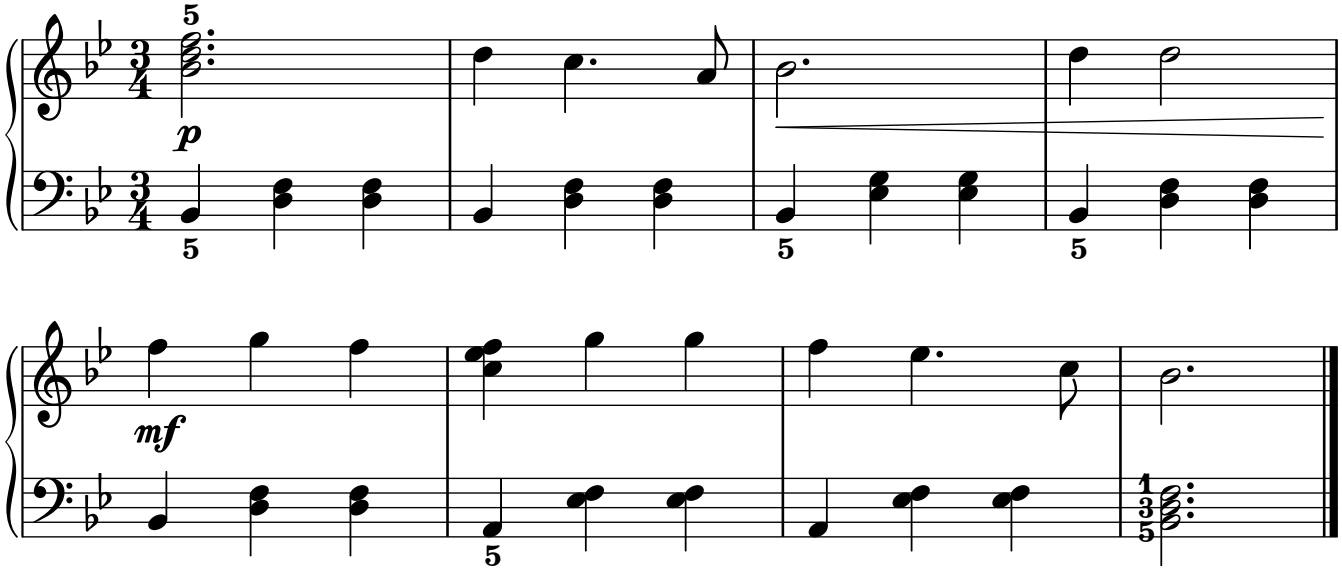


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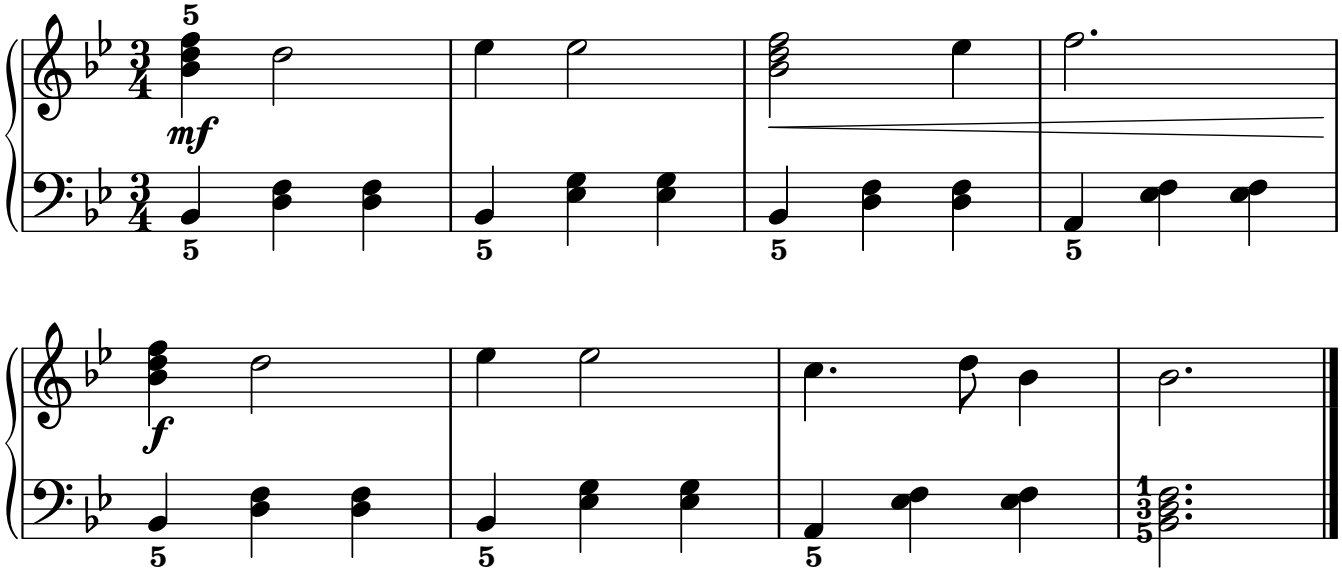


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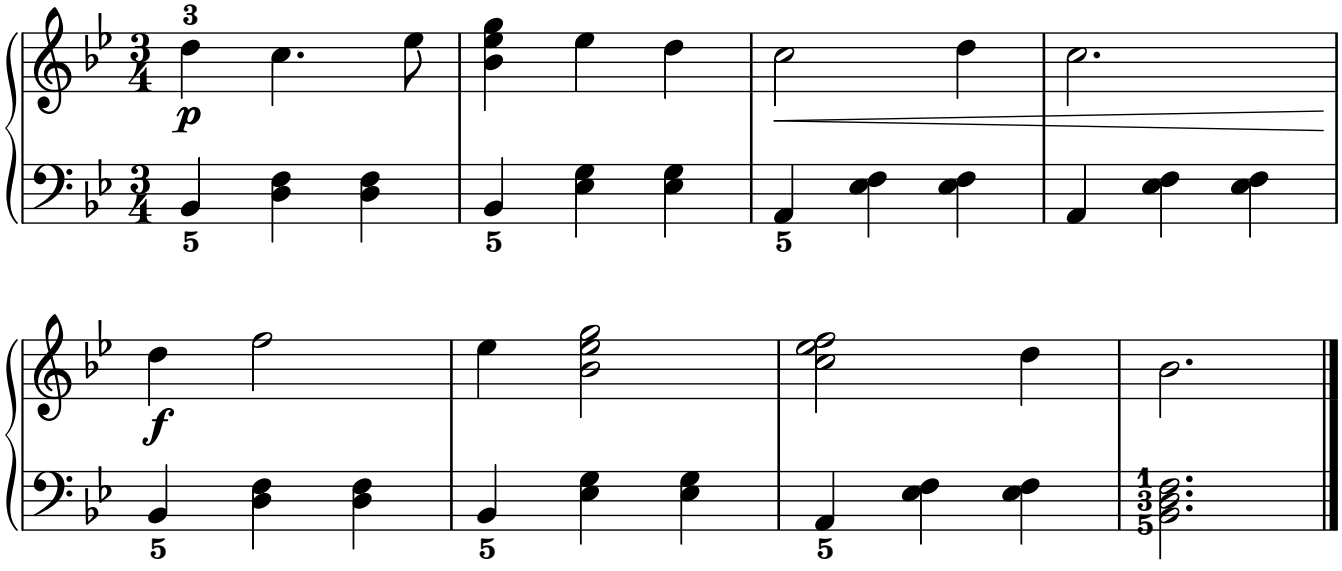
☐ **2.32**



☐ **2.33**



☐ **2.34**
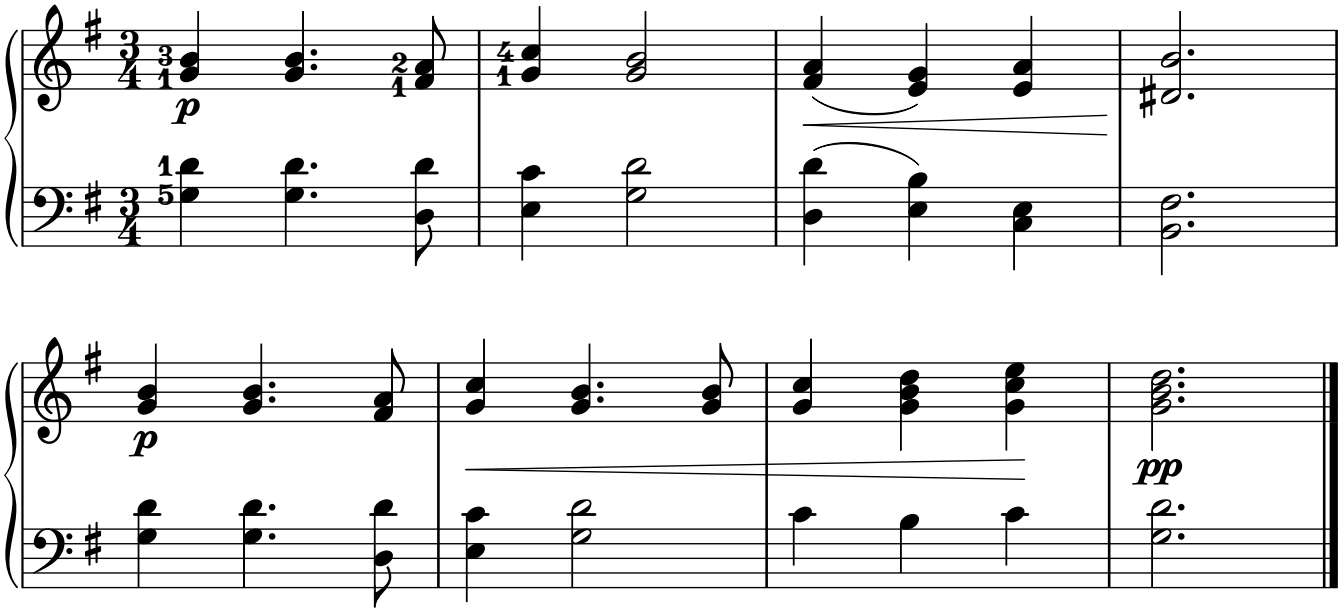


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Morning Prayer ♩ = 56

Pyotr Ilyich Tchaikovsky, Op. 39 No. 1 (opening and close) - simplified
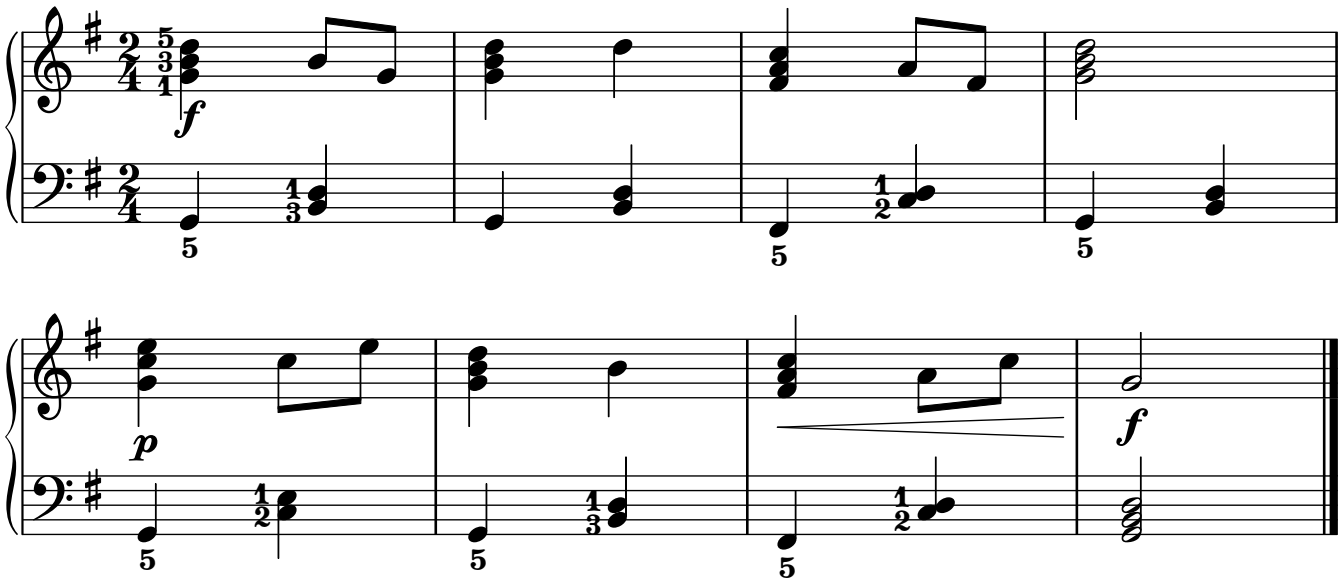
The first piece of Tchaikovsky's Album for the Young, a quiet chorale in both hands. Bars 1-4 are as Tchaikovsky wrote them (the left hand an octave higher); bars 5-8 shorten the rest of the piece. Bar 4 ends on a B major chord: D-sharp is its middle note. Source: Mutopia Project no. 2032.



Toy Soldiers' March ♩ = 96

Original

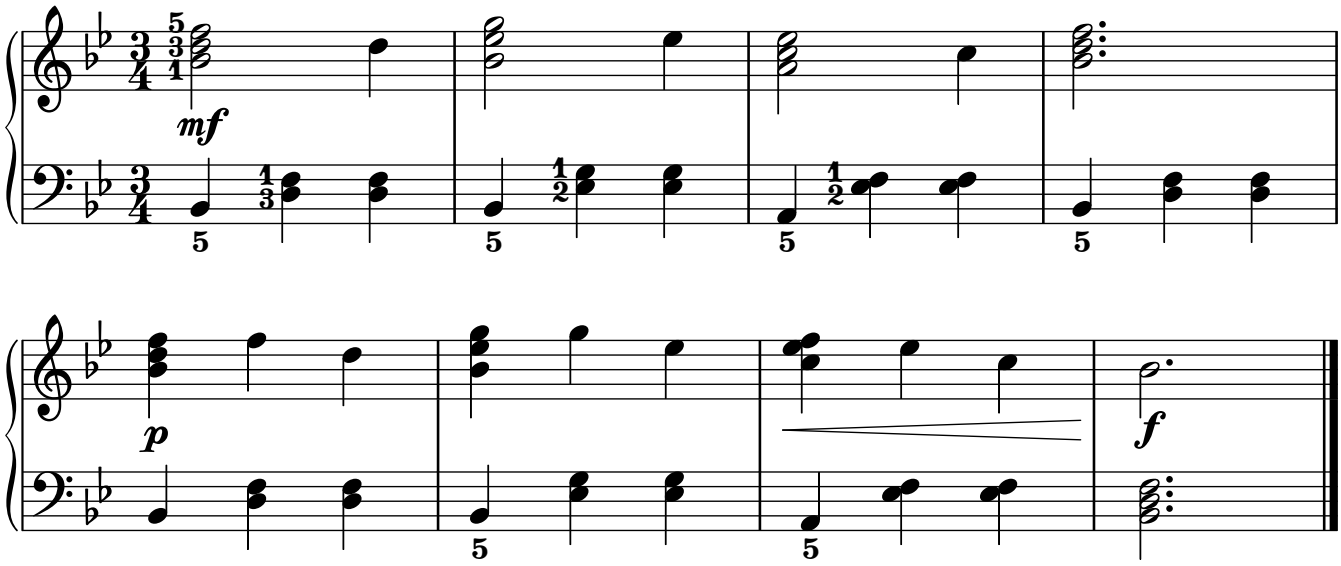
A march in 2/4. The right hand plays a chord on every first beat; the left hand plays oom-pah, one 'oom' and one 'pah' in each bar.



Grand Waltz in B-flat ♩ = 132

Original

Chords in both hands. The right hand's chords are B-flat D F (I), B-flat E-flat G (IV) and A C E-flat or C E-flat F (V7); finger 5 stretches up to G in bars 2 and 6.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 3?

- Play five new Part B to D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Every chord sounds together, and the top line of the right hand sings.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 3.